Shawn F. Murphy

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Profile:

I have managed to formalize the techniques that humans already use to advance science, culture, business and democracy — with the consequence that those collaborations can now be scaled, accelerated, perpetually refined, and rendered more inclusive, both of diverse perspectives and emerging artificial intelligences.

- **Software architect and lead engineer** of the MMM (a distributed, content-addressed, multi-perspectival semantic datastore) and ThinkerToys (its collaborative cognition browser) — integrating LLMs as epistemic participants rather than oracles, via agentic pipelines, WebComponents, Electron, Capacitor and Bun
- 35+ years building knowledge-intensive systems: semantic datastores, RDF/OWL/OKBC, dynamic visualization, distributed systems, ontologies, content-addressed storage, agentic AI pipelines, LLM integration
- Track record of building ahead of the moment: distributed hypertext for civil society (1987); game-theoretically robust pathways through the singularity (TechnoWatch, 1989); collaborative semantic visualization platforms (1991-); GFP in Perl and Java (1997); OKBC in Python (2002);
- Seeking to apply this work where epistemic integrity, collaborative cognition and AI safety intersect — as Staff Engineer, Researcher, or Architect

Professional Specialties: Collaborative Cognition, Knowledge Representation & Graphs, Semantic Web, LLM Integration, Agentic Pipelines, WebComponents, Distributed Systems, Version Control, AI, RDBMS, OOP, Functional, Cognitive Computing, Dynamic Graphics, Pattern Languages, DevOps, FOSS, Capability-Based Systems, CI/CD, Test Automation, Docker

Languages, Formats, APIs and DTDs:

- Python
- Javascript
- Typescript
- Coffeescript
- Postscript
- SQL
- Bash
- Rust
- Java
- C
- AWK
- ObjC
- Scheme
- Smalltalk
- LISP
- Nim
- HTML5
- CSS
- SVG
- XML
- jQuery/UI
- D3
- `<canvas>`
- `2d/webgl`
- Angular
- React
- Selenium
- DocBook
- SGML
- LaTeX
- Markdown
- Make
- RDF*
- OWL
- SPARQL
- N3
- TriG
- OKBC
- TMAPI
- CTM

Standards Implemented:

- TMDM
- Digest Auth
- OKBC
- RBAC
- RETS
- ANSI X12 EDI

Systems: Linux, MacOS, iOS, Android, Squeak, Minix, AS/400, OS/2, NeXTstep, Windows, Apple*II*

Software:

- Emacs
- SQLite
- Django
- GIMP
- NodeJS
- OrgMode
- MongoDB
- Flask
- Docker
- SalesForce
- GIT
- Oracle
- Medusa
- POVRay
- OpenSCAD
- Eclipse
- MySQL
- Zope
- Squeak
- GraphViz
- VirtualBox
- PostgreSQL
- Express
- Google Workspace
- ElasticSearch

Industries: Artificial Intelligence, Molecular Nanotechnology, Bioinformatics, Digital Humanities, B2B & B2C E-Commerce, Database Publishing, Grocery E-Commerce, Supply Chain Automation, Bibliographic Systems, Recruiting Systems, Fleet Automation & Tracking, Abuse Detection, Learning Management, Real Estate, Laboratory Information Management (LIMS)

Interests:

- A-Life
- Emergence
- Game Theory
- Nanotech
- Agorics
- Evolution
- GroupWare
- Noosphere
- Autopoesis
- Planetworking
- ISO-9000
- Singularity
- Design Patterns
- Quantified Self
- Markets
- Wearables

Education International Baccalaureate @ Lester B. Pearson College; CompSci, Phil, Phys, Math(Hon) 2yrs @ University of Alberta; Digital Electronics Tech @ SIAST; Bootcamp @ NeXT

Experience

Founder & CEO — Nooron Collaboratory Inc/UG
2015 to present — Edmonton, Saltspring, Berlin

Nooron is a long-term R&D project in pursuit of exponentiating collective human cognition. It consists of a novel semantic database backend and flexible frontend which includes knowledge management, data visualization and collective intelligence application development tools. Shawn leads this six person company and also serves as software architect and lead programmer. Nooron Inc is funded by angel investment; management services to consumer products vendors; and semantic software development services to Universities including Guelph, Alberta, Cambridge and Exeter.

Fullstack Software Engineer — Connectifier
2013 to 2014 — Orange County, California

Used Java, Scala, AngularJS, the Play Framework, MongoDB, Elastic Search and Selenium as part of a startup team to build a category leading recruiting platform. Connectifier used big data and machine learning techniques to crawl the web and social networks for CV and contact information to empower recruiters specialized in hiring software engineering talent. Shawn was their sixth engineer following the four initial Google software engineers. Shawn left to found Nooron Collaboratory. Connectifier was later acquired by LinkedIn.

Architect & Programmer — The Orlando Project
2013 to 2014 — Universities of Alberta, Guelph & McGill

Coding and architecting an animated highly interactive semantic visualization research platform using D3, Canvas, RDF and NodeJS for a university consortium working in the digial humanities. It features multi-modal interactivity (using direct manipulation; bulk specification and a novel semantic graph layout specification language) to support visual exploration of a large text corpus.

Founder, CTO, Architect — Semandra, Inc.
2011 to 2014 — Saltspring Island & Edmonton

Semandra provided full-service front-to-backend website development specializing in graphics-intensive designs with multimedia integration, database-driven backends with complex programming requirements, and content-rich user-maintainable CMS sites.

- Ponderate — an agile, collective knowledge curation and evaluation tool
- TOBFleet — a RESTful web service which simplifies vehicle fleet integrations
- Theamatic — a repertory theatre and film festival management site
- CReturns — a graphical scheduling system, e-commerce solution and SalesForce integration for this home energy auditing and retrofitting service

Principal — smurp.com
2002 to 2011 — Edmonton, AB

Smurp.com provided contract programming and consulting services with a focus on database-backed web sites and complex data processing operations.

- PyOKBC — A Python implementation of the *Open KnowledgeBase Connectivity* system of knowledge representation and abstraction. It was designed to provide a single consistent interface to diverse structured information sources, to include ontologies, relational databases, xml documents, and topic maps.
- PyRETS — An implementation of the *Real Estate Transaction System* for keeping the Vancouver Real Estate Board synchronized with MLS.ca
- CatPub — A database publishing technology consisting of a `POSTSCRIPT` templating system over a relational database back-end. Suitable for automatically preparing complex, highly customized, `POSTSCRIPT` and PDF publications such as directories and catalogs, it is closed source software created under contract for a firm providing publishing services to the real estate industry. It is producing on the order of 10 thousand unique catalog pages every day containing constantly changing data for the largest real estate boards in Western Canada.
- TKQ2.0 — A Django e-store system vending e-books for hundreds of educational publishers, through a dozen store-fronts, with sophisticated features such as promotions, steganographic watermarking in PDF, bundling, coupons and more.

- TKQW — A Medusa-based "digital drop-shipping" system enabling digital goods sale and delivery by untrusted 3rd parties.
- ModelViz — Added dynamic SVG-based touring facilities to this Django model entity-relationship visualizer.
- Alberta Lodging Association — A Zope Object Database for commercial lodgings backing a web site, a printed directory and associated advertising, sales and layout system.

Founder, Chair, VP R&D — Emergence by Design
1995 to 2003 — Edmonton, AB

Shawn founded Emergence by Design along with four colleagues to pursue the development of *The Idea Engine*. To fund the ongoing development of TIE, Shawn led EbD to become a dot-com factory, providing consulting, development, hosting and e-commerce services to new dot-com ventures. Shawn was Chairman, VP of R&D, lead developer and chief architect of this 15-person organization, until selling his interest in 2003.

- TheIdeaEngine — architect and lead developer of this R&D project developing a distributed knowledge representation system using Java (and JDBC), Perl (and DBI), Scheme, and various SQL backends. The effort included the implementation of the OKBC (Open Knowledge Base Connectivity) specification in Java and Perl, the authoring of a multithreaded knowledge server and the creation of many perl CGIs, Java Applets and Applications.
- GetCited.org — chief architect and lead developer on this massive, highly abstracted academic bibliographic portal system (a Google Scholar predecessor) built on Python, Zope and Oracle, featuring:
  - reference and citation cross-references
  - per-publication discusion forums
  - curriculum vitae management
  - links with Amazon and other vendors for associate referral income
  - seeded with MARC Book and Serials databases from Library of Congress
  - rich array of publication types (proceedings, books, articles, manuscripts, bibliographies, etc)
  - tracking of individual/institutional affiliations
  - sophisticated statistics on publishing influence of nations, institutions and individuals based on citation counts
- DedicatedTeacher.com — architect and lead developer for this highly abstracted e-commerce engine (built with Python, PostgreSQL and PS/pgSQL) featuring:
  - sells both 'digital-goods' (eg. MP3s and PDFs of books) and 'tangible goods' (printed books, CDs, educational kits)
  - complex shipping options
  - multiple suppliers per store
  - sophisticated coupon, bundle, sale and promotion features
  - serves store fronts for various companies (e.g. Scholastic)
  - supports multiple currencies, multiple credit-card transaction backends simultaneously and selectively (depending on currency, card-type, availability, etc.)
- Law Opinion — architect and developer of the worlds first E-Commerce facility for the provision of paid legal opinions. It included numerous encryption safeguards to ensure complete client confidentiality; a system for letting people pick the nearest lawyer with experience in the chosen area of the law; and a sophisticated, dynamic, system for performing branching automated interviews.
- FindAMentor.com — architect and lead developer of this system for helping people find and interact with professional and personal mentors; complete with anonymization and multiple personal profiles in different areas of interest

- EmailDirector — architect and developer of this school management system with parallel web and email interfaces and sophisticated email transaction system for, at that time, Canada's largest e-school with 2500 grade-school students
- EStore — architect and developer of this web interface for creating E-Commerce websites using NGage Electronic Commerce technology
- recruiter matchmaking system — salvaged, re-architected and built out a head-hunting firm's matchmaking system for staffing high-tech jobs based on skill, locality and position type
- ClickTrace — architect and developer of this web log mining facility
- Domainatrix — architect and developer of this toolset for bulk management of domain registrations, DNS configurations and network interface configuration
- Edmonton Chamber of Commerce Annual Directory — architect of this database-driven directory including ads and equivalents of white pages and yellow pages
- magazine publishing system — architect of this complete publishing solution with extensive features for advertising sales management and ad layout automation
- Web Developer Course — authored and taught classes in Linux command line skills; HTML and relational database design

Systems Analyst I, II & III — Gov't of Alberta
1989 to 1995 — Edmonton, AB

Shawn was responsible for analysis, design, programming, training and support of LABBASE: a multi-disciplinary LIMS (Laboratory Information Management System) coded in Paradox and WordBasic. It co-operated with a legacy AS/400 appliction written in RPG/400 and CL, which he also maintained, after performing forensic version control. During this project he managed three other programmers, the AS/400 administrator and a tech support person as well as providing Entity-Relationship modelling and RDBMS training for the government's scientific and administrative staff.

Principal — Sapient Systems
1990 to 1995 — Edmonton, AB

Sapient Systems specialized in the creation of desktop database apps.

- Wrote *FastEDI* in PAL (the Paradox Application Language) to provide a subset of the ANSI X.12 (V3.020) Electronic Data Interchange system for an oilfield supply company interested in easing the ordering process for the many regional offices of their large clients in the oil patch. *FastEDI v1.0* implemented the transaction sets for Price/Sales Catalog (832) and Purchase Order (850) thus enabling the electronic distribution of the latest pricelist and placement of orders.
- Created a *Disability Inventory & Assessment System* for an Educational Consultant to use as a proof of concept of her doctoral work for possible productization.
- Created a *Property Management System* for a Realty Firm to track the features, locations, prices and owners of available commercial real estate to facilitate showing to clients
- Attended "NeXT Developer Camp" and wrote *Elements.app*

Founder & Director — TechnoWatch Society
1990 to 1992 — Edmonton, AB

Founded think-tank devising game-theoretically robust pathways through the singularity — establishing intellectual priority on AI alignment, nanotech and biotech hazards before the field existed

Cofounder & Board — EcoCity Society
1990 to 1992 — Edmonton, AB, Canada

Founded, sat on the board, authored materials and attended international conferences regarding ecological design, education, legislative reforms and urban initiatives.